



Figure 1: Xposed installer 'Welcome' screen

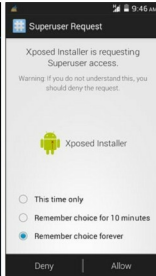


Figure 2: Super-user screen

to your device. Xposed offers a wide range of modules that can be downloaded under the *Download* section of the app, where you will find loads of them with a snippet of information about each module. To install a module, just tap on it, then click on the *Download* button and you will be prompted to install it. So, let's install a module. I selected Gravity Box, because it's my favourite. There are two versions of Gravity Box—one for JellyBean [JB] and another for Kitkat [KK]; so select accordingly. Then click on the *Download* button. After the download finishes, you will be prompted to install it. If not prompted, you can invoke the installer explicitly by tapping the *Install* button, which will appear next to the *Download* button after successful downloading. After installation, you have to activate the module, by going to the *Modules* section and checking it. Please note, the changes will only take place after rebooting. The list of *modules* is very vast, but here are my favourites in no particular order, which we will later use to customise our Android experience:

- GravityBox
- Tinted Status Bar [BETA]
- XHaloFloatingWindow
- App Settings
- MinMinGuard

To maintain the modules, just go to the *Modules* section, and if you want, *uncheck/check* a particular module.

If an update to the *Framework* or a module is available, you will be able to see it under the *Download* section. Now let's move on to customisation.

GravityBox

Installing GravityBox is just the start; the real fun lies in configuring it for better use. After installation, the GravityBox icon will appear in the app drawer. If you

open the app, you will find tons of customisation options, ranging from *Status Bar* tweaks to miscellaneous others. If the app asks for root access, you already know what to do. Under the *Status Bar* tweaks you can change the icon colour and the colour of the *Status Bar* too. You can also change the battery indicator to the one KitKat has, if you want to dress up your device with minute details. If you want an advanced power menu, you can go about getting one under *Power Tweaks*. My favourite tweak of GravityBox is the *Expanded Desktop* mode, which gives you extra screen space to run apps by hiding the notification bar. It can be enabled under the *Display* tweaks. Once you enable it, you can find the option to expand the desktop under your power menu, like in Figure 3. Also, the *Transparency Management* option gives you the power to make the *Status Bar* and *Navigation Bar* mimic the transparent *Status Bar* of KitKat. There are too many options to discuss, so go ahead and explore and experiment.

Tinted Status Bar

This module gives you a consistent and seamless look throughout the apps on your system. It changes the *Status Bar* colour with the present app open, much like the Chameleon feature of Unity. So, open up the app, and if it asks for root access, give it the privilege. If you see a list of apps installed on it, you can enable/disable individual apps by tapping on the app and toggling the *On/Off* button. Now, if you want an app that has a distinct colour like VLC (which has a dominant orange colour), you will see *Status Bar* turn orange.

XHaloFloatingWindow

This module brings the famous Halo Popup floating window feature from Paranoid Android. It can be used as with the Floating Notifications app to get a closer Halo experience; however, we will keep it simple. First download and install the module, then open up the app and it will ask for root access. Now, activate the module with a reboot. To test the app, open the *XHaloFloatingWindow* app from the drawer, go to the *Testing Area*, and try and launch any of the tests. I chose to launch *Xposed Installer* in Halo. Now, let's configure opening the notifications in Halo mode. Open the app and go to *SystemUI Mods*, and check the *Long Press Notifications Option* and *Long Press Recent Apps*. Now, if you want to open a notification from an app in Halo mode, you will have to long press on notification. If you don't like to long press every time you want to open the notification, you can check the *Single Click* option as well. It will work for most apps but not with some apps like Play Store and Terminal Emulator; even if you try to open them in Halo mode, they will open in default mode. The *Long Press Recent Apps* option does the same. This module is extremely useful when you are browsing and you receive a notification from your